Verizon Data Services India Private Limited

Locations: Chennai / Hyderabad / Bangalore
Role: Engineer *(This is a hiring process that spans across various domains within the organization)*

About Verizon:

Verizon is a global telecom leader driving innovation in 5G, IoT, and cloud technologies. Established in 2001, Verizon Data Services India plays a key role in the company's global operations, focusing on tech development and business support. With over 7,000 professionals across Chennai, Hyderabad, and Bengaluru, Verizon India is a major innovation hub.

READ THIS FIRST!!

- Please note that a formal Pre-Placement Talk (PPT) was not conducted for this company. However, they held a connect session during the 6th semester, which is highly recommended as it offers valuable insights into the company and hiring process.
- While topics like Generative AI and AI Prompting were mentioned during interviews, I wasn't asked any AI-specific questions. That said, it's important to be well-prepared for domain-specific questions, as interviews are based on the domain the company is considering you for (which they will inform you about).
- At the time of application, specific roles weren't disclosed. When I asked during the interview, I was told candidates may get to choose their preferred domain—such as SDE, Full Stack, AI/ML, etc.
- If the Job Description (JD) doesn't clearly mention the role, it's a good idea to ask your interviewer for clarification. It shows initiative and helps align your strengths with the right opportunity.

Day 1: Online Assessment (13th Sept 2025) – Virtual Mode

Platform: AON

Section 1: Essay Writing (15 mins)

We were asked to write an essay on the topic:
"The spending habits of today's youth are quite different compared to previous generations."

There was a strict word limit — essays below the minimum word count were not evaluated, and exceeding the limit by even one word was not allowed. The test platform featured a real-time word counter, enabling us to monitor our word count as we wrote.

The best approach was to write naturally and let the word counter guide the length, rather than stressing about the limit from the beginning.

Section 2: MCQs on AI (30 mins)

This section consisted of 30 multiple-choice questions; all related to Artificial Intelligence. The questions were general and not overly difficult, covering basic AI concepts and applications.

There was no negative marking, so I attempted all the questions. It's advisable to do the same, as there's no penalty for incorrect answers.

Section 3: Coding (45 mins)

This round consisted of 2 coding questions.

Question 1: Given an integer N, determine whether it is GOOGLY or NOT GOOGLY.
A number is considered GOOGLY if the sum of its digits is a prime number.

Constraints:
1 ≤ N ≤ 10^9

Examples:

Input: 21

Sum of digits = 2 + 1 = 3 → prime → **Output:** GOOGLY

Input: 13

Sum of digits = 1 + 3 = 4 → not prime → **Output:** NOT GOOGLY

Code: C++

```
#include<iostream>
using namespace std;
int main() {
    long long N;
    cin >> N;
    bool primeIdx[82] = {false};
    int primes[] = {2, 3, 5, 7, 11, 13, 17, 19, 23, 29, 31, 37, 41, 43, 47, 53, 59,
61, 67, 71, 73, 79} ;
    for( int p : primes ) { primeIdx[p] = true; }
    int sum = 0;
    while( N > 0 ) {
        sum += N % 10;
        N /= 10;
    }
    if( primeIdx[sum]) { cout << "GOOGLY"; }
    else { cout << "NOT GOOGLY"; }
    return 0;
}
```

Time Complexity: O(82) (for the primes array initialization) + O(d) (for the while loop) ≈ O(d), where d is the number of digits in the given number.

Space Complexity: O(82) (for primeIdx array) + O(22) (for primes array) ≈ O(1)

Question 2: Given an array A of size N, you can perform the following operation any number of times: Select any subarray and replace it with its sum. Your task is to maximize the length of a non-decreasing array after performing such operations optimally.

Constraints:

3 ≤ N ≤ 10^5

1 ≤ A[i] ≤ 10^5

Examples:

Input: N = 7

A = [5, 1, 6, 3, 4, 2, 8]

Optimal merge: Merge [1, 6] → 7, [3, 4] → 7, [2, 8] → 10

Resulting array: [5, 7, 7, 10] → Length = 4

Another valid merge: [5+1] = 6, [3+4] = 7, [2+8] = 10

Resulting array: [6, 6, 7, 10] → Length = 4

Output: 4

Input: N = 5

A = [5, 4, 3, 2, 1]

Only option to make non-decreasing: Merge [4, 3, 2, 1] → 10

Resulting array: [5, 10] → Length = 2

Output: 2

This is similar to [Maximize non decreasing Array size by replacing Subarray with sum] in GFG but can be solved using greedy approach.

Code: C++

```
#include <bits/stdc++.h>
using namespace std;
int main() {
	int N;
	cin >> N;
	vector<long long> A(N);
	for (int i = 0; i < N; i++) { cin >> A[i]; }
	long long last = 0, sum = 0;
	int count = 0;
	for (int i = 0; i < N; i++) {
		sum += A[i];
		if (sum >= last) {
			count++;
			last = sum;
			sum = 0;
		}
	}
	cout << count;
	return 0;
}
```

Time Complexity: O(N)

Space Complexity: O(1)

Section 4: Vocabulary + Logical Reasoning (Rapid Fire)

This was a rapid-fire round designed to test both speed and accuracy. The section was divided into four timed sub-sections:

- Logical Reasoning
- English Vocabulary
- Sentence Completion (Choose the correct word)
- Spelling (Identify the correct spelling)

Key Details:

- Each sub-section had a fixed time limit with a rapid stream of questions.
- Some sub-sections included negative marking for incorrect answers.
- The number of questions was not fixed — the goal was to answer as many as possible within the time limit.

Strategy & Tips:

- Attempt all questions in sub-sections without negative marking.
- In sub-sections with negative marks, answer only if you're confident about the correct answer to avoid penalties.
- Speed and accuracy are both crucial — stay alert and manage your time wisely.

80 students were shortlisted for the next round.

Day 2: (16^{th} Sept 2025) - **Venue:** CUIC – Offline mode

Round 1: Group Discussion

Topic: Impact of E-Commerce (Amazon, Flipkart, etc.) and Food Delivery Services (Swiggy, Zomato, etc.) on Society

Evaluation Criteria: Fluency, Leadership, Clarity, Validity of Points, Body Language, and Attitude.

80 students were divided into 9 teams, with 8 teams of 9 members each and 1 team of 8. We had just 1 minute to prepare without using phones. There were 9 members in our GD, and one recruiter evaluated us. This was an eliminatory round.

Tips:

- Even with limited prep time, the topics were easy to tackle.
- Focus on quality over quantity; ensure your points move the discussion forward.
- During our GD, one member's point was slightly off-topic, but we quickly got it back on track.
- It's important to stay mindful of the discussion's flow. We made sure everyone had space to contribute, which helped foster good team dynamics.

Results were announced immediately. In our team, 7 were shortlisted for next round. Overall, out of 80 students, 55 were shortlisted for next round.

Round 2: AI Prompting (Laptop is mandatory)

- Immediately after the GD, we were asked to participate in the AI prompting round, which started while the GD for other teams was still ongoing. A Google Form link was sent to our registered email addresses, where we were asked to fill in basic details.
- Once we filled the details, we had to select a problem statement from a provided set of options. For the chosen problem, we were required to craft a prompt that, when given to an AI tool like ChatGPT, Gemini, or others, would generate a solution to the problem.
- In essence, the task involved submitting both the prompt and the prompting technique we would use to effectively retrieve the solution from the AI tools.
- This round was non-eliminatory, but the prompts we submitted would be discussed in the technical interview round, where we would be asked questions about the techniques used in our prompts.
- We were allowed to use any AI tools, such as ChatGPT, Claude, etc., to assist in crafting our responses.

Round 3: Technical Interview (30 mins)

- After the AI Prompting round, I was called for the technical interview. I was lucky to have a very relaxed and polite interviewer, which made the experience enjoyable.
- We started with greetings and brief introductions. The interviewer then reviewed my resume and began with the education section. After that, he moved on to discuss my projects, paying particular attention to my Machine Learning project. I explained it in detail, and he followed up with technical questions related to the tech stack I mentioned in the projects. Questions like ReactJS vs. React Native and MongoDB vs. Firebase were asked, and they were fairly easy to answer.
- Next, he asked about my skills, starting with my most familiar programming language, to which I said C++. He asked several in-depth questions about C++, such as the types of variables in C++, how to use functions from a class defined in another file, what the Standard Template Library (STL) is, and why one would choose C++ over C.
- We then moved on to Object-Oriented Programming (OOP) concepts. He asked questions like the primary benefit of polymorphism and what object slicing is. Afterward, he asked behavioral questions related to the soft skills I mentioned in my resume.
- We also discussed my hobbies, which led to a really fun and engaging conversation.
- At the end of the interview, he said, “It was really good talking to you,” and asked if I had any questions. I clarified the role I was being considered for and inquired about the company culture. We exchanged goodbyes, and the interview concluded.

After waiting for over 4 hours, I was shortlisted for the next round. Out of 55 students, 32 were selected to move forward.

<u>Round 4:</u> HR Round (5 – 10 mins)

- The HR round felt more like a formality for me. The interviewer greeted me, introduced himself, and instead of asking for a typical introduction, he asked me to explain my resume in detail.
- After that, he asked a few questions about my Machine Learning project, followed by why I chose Anna University for my studies and why I wanted to work at Verizon. He then inquired about my family background and my willingness to relocate.
- The conversation was quite straightforward, and we wrapped up with mutual greetings, bringing the interview to a close.

After all 32 candidates completed the HR round, we were asked to gather in the mini auditorium at CUIC for the results. While the interviewers discussed the selections, I received an email saying, “Congratulations on your selection!” from Verizon. To my surprise, all 32 of us received the same email. It turns out that everyone who participated in the HR round was selected and offered the position.

<u>Insights and Thoughts:</u>

- As I mentioned earlier, I wasn’t asked any questions related to AI prompting or Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA) during my interview. In fact, the interviewer didn’t even bring up the AI Prompting round. However, many of my friends were asked detailed questions on AI, prompting techniques, and were even given DSA problems to solve.
- So, my strong recommendation is to be well-prepared for domain-related questions, especially in AI, prompting, and DSA, regardless of how your interviewer turns out to be.
- My HR interviewer was calm, friendly, and made the interview feel relaxed. It lasted barely 10 minutes. But not everyone had the same experience—another HR was much stricter, asked more intense and stress-inducing questions, and made the interview quite pressurizing for some of my friends.
- Be ready to face any type of interviewer—whether they’re calm or challenging.
- The overall process was smooth, though the wait time for the final results was a bit long.

<u>Final Tip:</u>

- Start preparing for your interviews as early as possible to avoid last-minute stress.
- A solid understanding of your resume, projects, technical concepts, and domain-related topics can make a big difference.

Hope this helps you :)

All the best for your interview!

Feel free to ping me if you have any questions,

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